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CSCI/ISAT B145 Fall 2025 - Final Project Game Description Template (for Project Proposal)
REMINDER: if you are a Mac user and you are using Pages instead of Microsoft Word as your word processing application, ***please*** **export this document to Microsoft Word format** (*.docx) before submitting. Thanks ☺

- ☐ In addition to a completed version of this **gameplay description document**, you'll be expected to provide additional deliverables that comprise the remaining elements of your final project proposal:
- ☐ A complete **noun/verb list** derived directly from your gameplay description (you may use the example shown in class as a *template*)
- ☐ **Clear photos of your handwritten CRC cards** — please make sure they are scaled and rotated properly so that they are easy to read. I recommend you embed your CRC card photos in a Word document so that you can organize them nearly and logically — do not simply upload a bunch of JPGs or PNG files.
- ☐ A **complete set of anticipated *user stories***, written from the standpoint of the *player* of your game and from the standpoint of the *developer/artist,* so that all planned game features are "covered." Please organize your user stories into *categories* — you may use the example shown in class as a template to follow, but please write all of your individual user stories "from scratch" rather than simply copy-pasting those found in the example shown in class.

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1. **Title**: In the space below, write the proposed title of your game. It's possible you might change this later, but try to come up with something *original* and *appropriate*, even if it's "placeholder."

   The Alright Spiderman: And the Four Symbols

2. **Summary**: In the space provided below, write a one-sentence overall general description of your game that could potentially be used for marketing or advertising purposes. *[For example: **Crabs vs. Lobsters** is an exciting two-player race game with elements of luck, strategy, and action — reach your goal zone first while capturing your opponent's pieces and navigating safe spaces. Or for another example: **Little Crab** is a challenging "eat & run"-style action game where you must eat worms on a sandy beach while evading menacing lobsters, all before time runs out!]*

   The Alright Spiderman: The Race for the gems is an action packed collect and shoot game, as Spiderman is trying to save the Universe from the Argol Demon star and his evil scheme .

3. **Information about the *humanistic* content of your game (your symbols and how they are connected):**
   a. In the table below, please list the **four symbols** (and their metadata) that were assigned to you for this project. *(For your convenience, you may copy this information directly from the Excel spreadsheet that was posted on Blackboard.)*

Symbol name	**Symbol metadata (time period, region of origin, short description)**
Algol / Demon Star (Greek – Arabic stronomy)	Algol is a three-star system, consisting of Beta Persei Aa1, Aa2, and Ab – in which the hot luminous primary β Persei Aa1 and the larger, but cooler and fainter, β Persei Aa2 regularly pass in front of each other, causing eclipses.
Breast[;ate of Aaron (Ancient Israel)	The Breastplate of Aaron was a sacred garment worn by the High Preiest in ancient Israel, know as the "Breastplate of Judgment" or "Breastplate of Decision".

Mandala (Tibet/South Asia)	A mandala is a spiritual diagram representing the universe and a map to enlightenment
Loa (Haiti, Vodou)	In Haitian Vodou, Loa are the spiritsthat act as intermediaries between the supreme creator, Bondye, and Humanity

b. Based on your scholarly research into the above symbols that were assigned to you, what are you proposing as far as how your symbols can be "connected" in terms of your game's *overall* design or underlying narrative? (Note: at this point I'm looking for broad narrative themes that can connect your symbols together in a coherent way; you will provide more detail on gameplay later in this document.) Write your response as a series of paragraphs in the space below, with citations of your research sources in IEEE format (see part `c` below for more). **Limit the overall length of your response to 250 words or fewer.** *To give you an example to follow, I asked Claude.ai to prepare a completely made-up example of a short essay that includes IEEE-style citations and a bibliography: https://claude.ai/share/e1e7fa80-bb44-4f72-a110-14cf82acdbef*

Many cultures have tried to connect the physical to the spiritual using sacred symbols and by looking at the stars. With the Loa, in vodou, they try connect humanity and transcendent Bondye, which serves as individual spirits that help guide, protect, or challenge human beings [1]. The mandala is a kind of spiritual guide as it is a spiritual diagram repesenting the universe and a map that leads to enlightenment[5]. Both of these symbols are emphasizing order and each spirit or geometric form helps lead to a larger spiritual harmony, reflecting a cosmic design that can guide people in finding meaning.
The Breast Plate of Aaron and the star Algol are also way that people are attemping to communicate with the divine whether through rituals or celestial signs. The twelve gems on the breastplate represent the twelve tribe of Israel[4].

c. In the space below, provide a short bibliography that follows the **IEEE citation format**, which is the same format used by ACM. (You may find this handy IEEE Citation Generator helpful: https://www.mybib.com/tools/ieee-citation-generator)

[1] "Lwa," *Wikipedia*, Sep. 03, 2022. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lwa
[2] Wikipedia Contributors, "Mandala," *Wikipedia*, Jan. 09, 2019. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mandala
[3] Wikipedia Contributors, "ALGOL," *Wikipedia*, Sep. 14, 2019. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/ALGOL
[4] "Priestly breastplate," *Wikipedia*, Mar. 23, 2024. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Priestly_breastplate
[5]"OpenAthens / Sign in," *Ebsco.com*, 2025. https://research.ebsco.com/c/tr6t4f/viewer/pdf/fwgtzmw2lv (accessed Nov. 03, 2025).

4. **Description of Stage 1:**

a. In the space provided below, write a paragraph of **no more than 250 words** that describes the *gameplay* of stage 1. Be sure to include, in whatever order makes the most sense to you:
    I. Establish a **visual context** (so someone can easily picture the game in their heads): Provide a brief description of the characters, obstacles, and other scenery that appear on screen. (If you have a sketch of the level design you can include that as well, but it is not required.)
    II. Briefly describe how you **interact** with your player character (keyboard controls, mouse, etc.)
    III. Provide a description of how the gameplay for **Stage 1** is *clearly* related or inspired by the **symbols** that were assigned to you
        - **NOTE:** I'd prefer you avoid gaming jargon if you can avoid it (not everyone who judges your game is necessarily a "gamer"), so if you need a "glossary" of gameplay jargon to help describe what's happening in your game in alternative terms, please use this resource: https://www.makeuseof.com/tag/learn-the-lingo-common-gaming-terms-you-should-know/
    IV. If it's not already mentioned, be sure to describe *concisely* what can cause a "game over" condition during this stage
    V. If it's not already mentioned, be sure to describe *concisely* how your player can complete this stage and move onto the next

The Alright Spiderman: And the Four Symbols will be a top down view game, where spiderman the main character is moving freely around the map. The gems from the Breastplate of Aaron are appearing all around the map. Spiderman has to collect these gems but with every 3 gems he collects the game gets a little harder as the spirit that are after spiderman take more damage to kill. The Agol will send evil spirits to attack Spiderman. Spiderman will be able to shoot web projectiles that when they come in contact with a spirit that is sent from the Demon star it will destroy it. The more gems you collect the harder it will be to defeat these spirits. The Loa blessings will be used a power up that will appear in a random spot on the map every 15 seconds. Theses power ups will grant Spiderman Special powers that will help him defeat the spirits. Once Spiderman collects the first 6 gems he will be able to go to the next stage.

5. **Description of Stage 2:**
    a. In the space provided below, write a paragraph of **no more than 250 words** that describes the *gameplay* of stage 2. Be sure to include, in whatever order makes the most sense to you:
        I. Establish a **visual context** (so someone can easily picture the game in their heads): Provide a brief description of the characters, obstacles, and other scenery that appear on screen. (If you have a sketch of the level design you can include that as well, but it is not required.)
        II. Briefly describe how you interact with your player character (keyboard controls, mouse, etc.)
        III. Provide a description of how the gameplay for **Stage 2** is *clearly* related or inspired by the **symbols** that were assigned to you
            - **NOTE:** I'd prefer you avoid gaming jargon if you can avoid it (not everyone who judges your game is necessarily a "gamer"), so if you need a "glossary" of gameplay jargon to help describe what's happening in your game in alternative terms, please use this resource: https://www.makeuseof.com/tag/learn-the-lingo-common-gaming-terms-you-should-know/

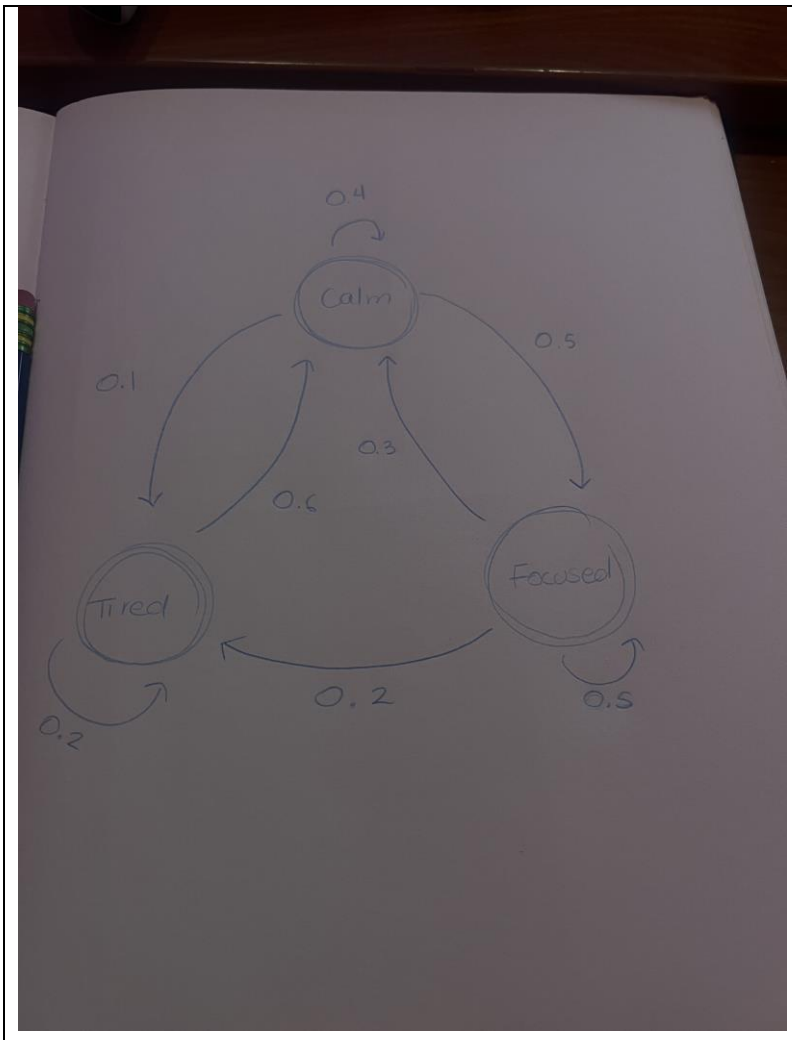
IV. If it's not already mentioned, be sure to describe *concisely* what can cause a "game over" condition during this stage
V. If it's not already mentioned, be sure to describe *concisely* how your player can complete this stage (and thus "win the game")

In this stage a Spiderman will once again be facing the evil spirits but now they are able to shoot him and they take longer to defeat. Spiderman will have three different states (calm, focused, tired) Calm is his normal state. After time he could enter his focused state where he moves fast end able to shoot his webs faster. Once he uses his focus mode there is chance he could be tired of he could go back to his calm state. Once all twelve of the gems are collected a display message will appear and say "Mission Completed: Balance Restored".

6. **Description of state machines that you expect to use in your game:**
   a. In the space below, and in **200 words or fewer**, write a clear description of how some aspect of your game will involve at least one **finite state machine.** You can have multiple FSMs, but you must have *at least one* FSM, and at least one of your FSMs must be controlled by a Markov chain**.** (In other words: if you currently expect to have only one FSM, then that FSM **must be controlled by a Markov chain** where you have estimated the probability of transitioning from each state to any other state or to itself. But you can have additional *deterministic* FSMs that do not involve probabilities but whose transitions are instead based strictly on certain game conditions being met.)

One finite state machine that I am planning to implement is a behavioral state machine. This will react based on how Spiderman is doing in the game. He will start off in a calm state. Once he collects 3 gems there is a chance that he could go into a state of focus where he moves faster. If he takes damage, he will enter and focused state that will allow him to shoot webs out at a higher rate. If he is exhausted, he will begin to move slower and there will be a slower rate of web shooting

   b. In the space below copy-paste a diagram of each of the FSMs you described above. (There may be tools online, such as LucidChart, for helping to draw FSMs and Markov chain diagrams, but it might be easier to draw your diagrams **by hand** and just take a photo. Do your best!)



7. **Enabling <u>tangential learning</u>**:
   a. In the space below, briefly describe what "tangential learning" actually *means,* **<u>in your own words</u>** (watch the Extra Credits YouTube video on "tangential learning" if you need a refresher. You'll find a link to this video in the Final Project Announcement PDF previously shown in class and posted on Blackboard.) **Please make every attempt to articulate your definition in a way <u>*that is meaningful to you*</u> — do not just write down what is described in the video or what you find online.**

   Tangential learning is whenever you are doing a task with one idea in mind and then because of the content that is in that task you learn form the work that you have done.

   b. <u>In the space below, describe how the gameplay can ***implicitly*** (i.e., ***passively***) enable tangential learning</u>. That is, what elements of the *gameplay experience* itself might want to make the player want to learn more about the historical inspiration or underlying historical theme for your game? Be creative and thoughtful here, but be aware that some players might not always recognize what you believe to be an implicit "catalyst" for enabling tangential learning — consequently, you need to explain how you believe the design or presentation of your game can *potentially draw attention to the underlying historical*

inspiration or theme for your game **without** explicitly pointing it out to the player. [NOTE: You'll provide more *explicit* or "active" mechanisms for tangential learning in part (c), as noted below.] Just make sure you are referencing something real and factual — you can still do "world-building" in your game if you like, but there must be a *clear connection* to some actual, factual, historical element. **Please provide citations in the form of short descriptions and URLs (web links) so that I know what historical sources you are referencing.**

I think that my game play can implicitly enable tangential by possibly have the picture of the mandala in the background for the world[5]. The user could be interested in the design and want to look up it is.

c. In the space below, provide a description of how additional game features can ***explicitly*** (i.e., ***actively***) enable tangential learning. That is, how can the use of additional "non-game" elements (such as your game's title screen, an intro screen, ending screen, intermissions, cutscenes, etc.) provide **just enough information** to get the player interested in exploring your topic? For example, you can use these information screens to explicitly state how the various elements of your game are inspired by real historical events, archaeological artifacts, references in literature, and so forth. As noted in part (b) above, please make sure you are referencing something real and factual — you can still do "world-building" in your game if you like, but there must be a *clear connection* to some actual, factual, historical element. **Please provide citations in the form of short descriptions and URLs (web links) so that I know what historical sources you are referencing.**

Since I have the Algol Demon Star as this games antagonist I could use the Title Screen to display a picture of the constellation. For the first gem of Aarons Breast Plate that I collect I could have a small drop down menu describing its history and explain to the user that they must collect all 12 to win the game or level.

User Stories

As a player, I want Spiderman to move using arrow keys, so that I can freely explore the map.

As a player, I want Spiderman to collect gems, so that I can progress through the game and unlock new stages.

As a player, I want gems to appear randomly on the map, so that each playthrough feels dynamic and unpredictable.

As a player, I want the game to get harder every time Spiderman collects 3 gems, so that the challenge increases with progress.

As a player, I want Algol to send evil spirits to attack Spiderman, so that I have enemies to fight and avoid.

As a player, I want Spiderman to shoot web projectiles, so that I can defeat spirits sent from the Demon Star.

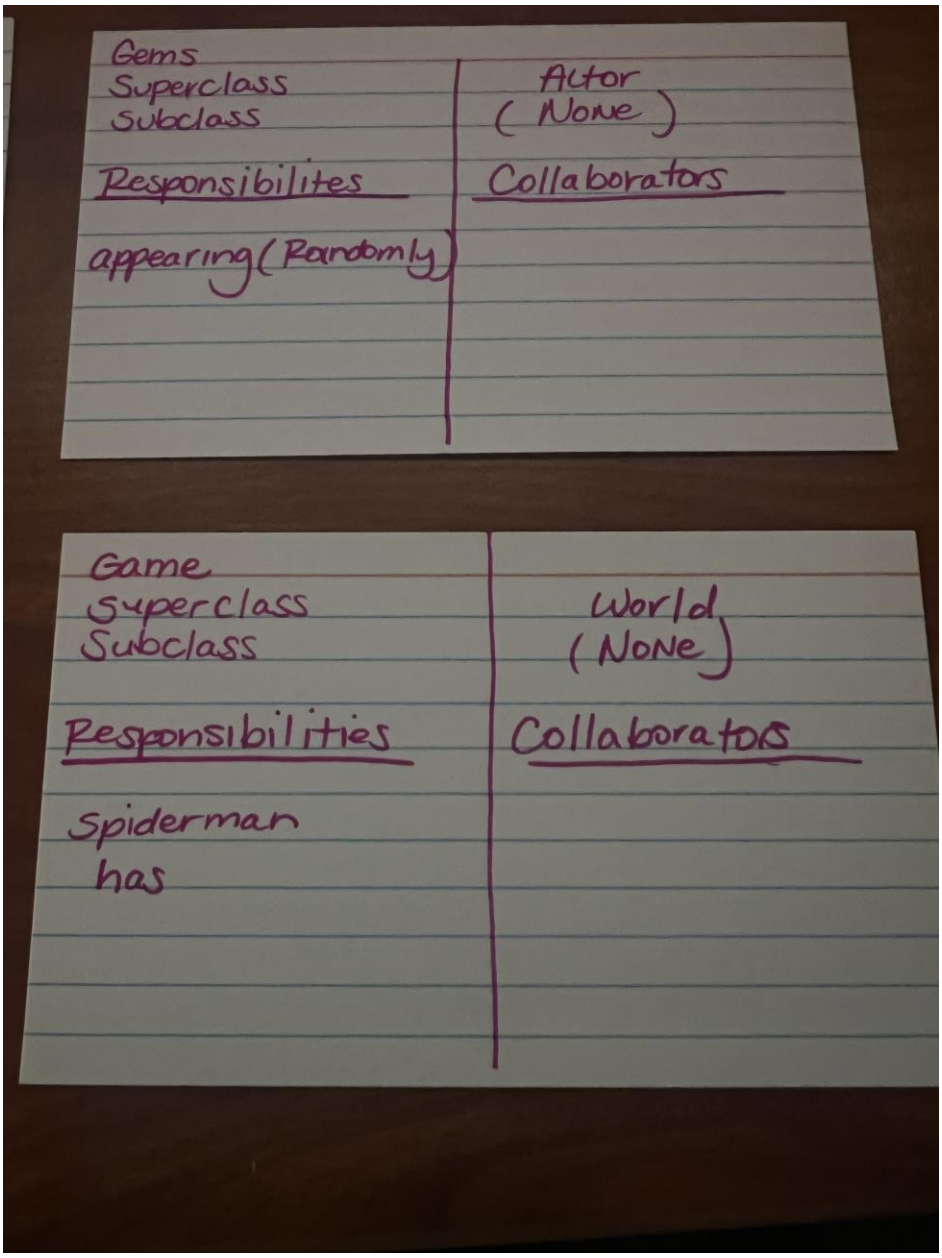
As a player, I want Loa blessings to appear randomly every 15 seconds, so that I can find power-ups during gameplay.

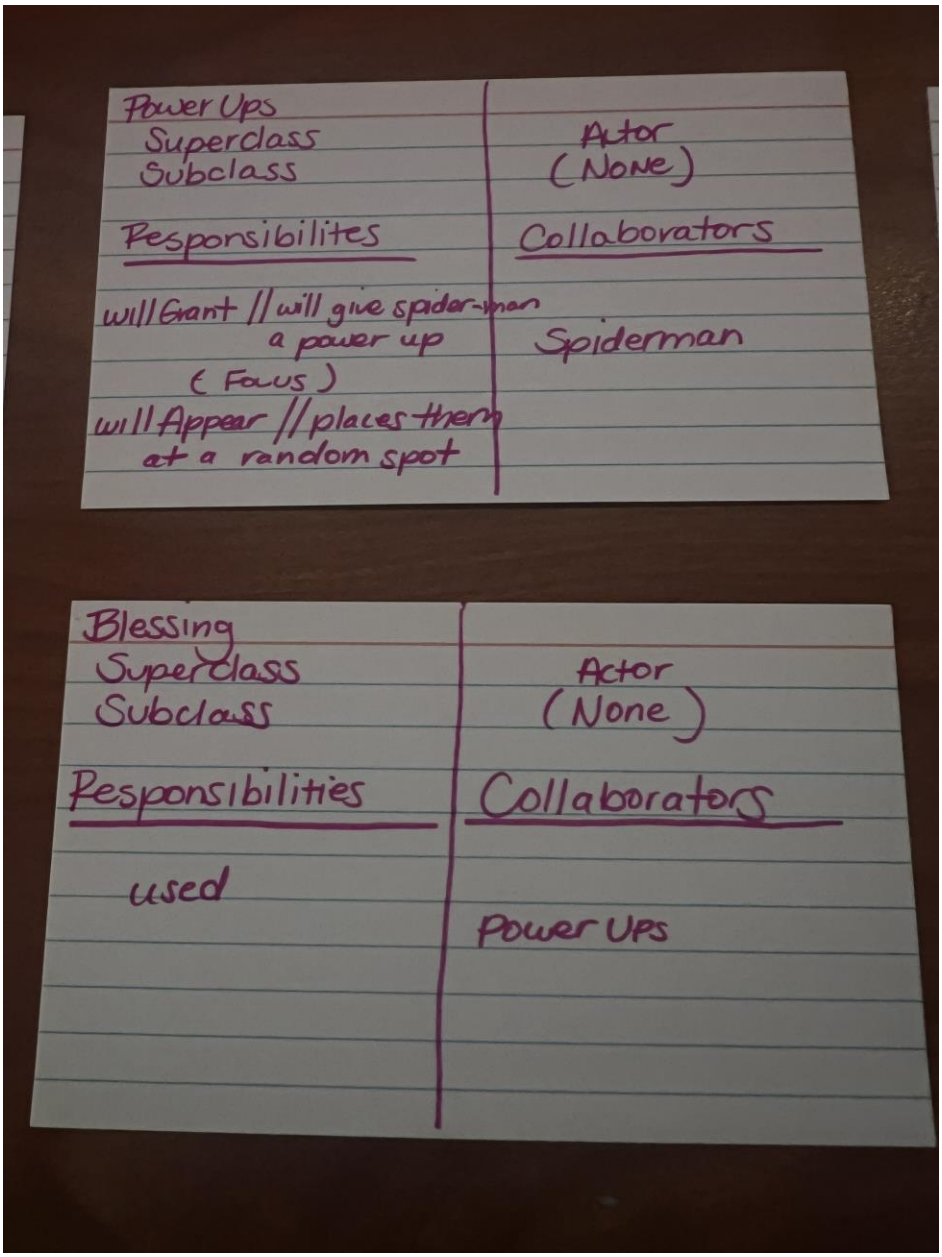
As a player, I want power-ups to grant Spiderman special powers, so that I can more effectively defeat spirits.

As a player, I want Spiderman to go to the next stage after collecting 6 gems, so that I can advance in the game.

As a player, I want Spiderman to have access to blessings and powers, so that I can customize my strategy against enemies.

CRC Cards


Gems
Superclass
Subclass
Actor
(None)
Responsibilites
Collaborators
appearing(Randomly)
Game
Superclass
Subclass
World
(None)
Responsibilities
Collaborators
Spiderman
has



Power Ups
Superclass
Subclass

Actor
(None)

Responsibilites

Collaborators

willGrant // will give spider-man a power up (Faus)

Spiderman

willAppear // places them at a random spot

Blessing
Superclass
Subclass

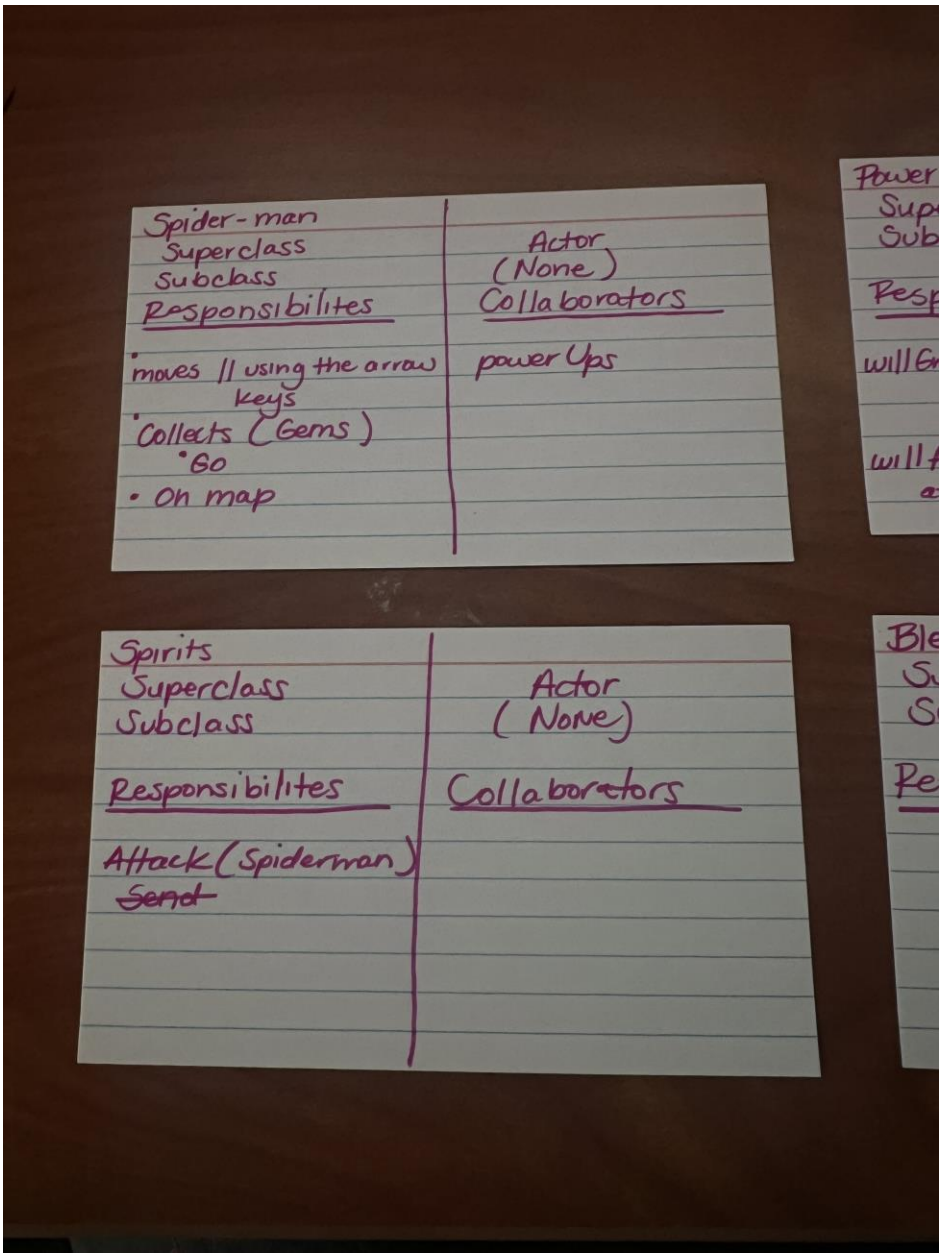
Actor
(None)

Responsibilities

Collaborators

used

Power Ups



Nouns	Associated verbs or verbs phases
- Spiderman - Spiderman - Gems - Game - Algol - Spirits - Blessing	- Moves // using the arrow keys - Collects (Gems) - Appearing (Randomly) - GetsHarder // difficulty increases - Send(spirits) - Attack(Spiderman) - Used

- PowerUps - PowerUps - Spiderman - 0 (space holder) - Spiderman - Spiderman - Map	- WillGrant // will give spiderman a power up - Willappear // places them at random spot on the map - Defeat(spirits) - Collects (Gems) - Go // moves spiderman to the next stage - Has (Spiderman)